

Arrays

Learning Outcomes

- LO 1.1 Explain memory representation of arrays*
- LO 1.2 Implement insertion, deletion, and search operations in arrays*
- LO 1.3 Analyze time complexity in array operations*
- LO 1.4 Diagnose array-related implementation errors*

Setting the Expectations

PREREQUISITES

- Understood the **basic programming concepts**—variable declaration, mathematical operations, selection and looping constructs, and functions.
- Utilized **arrays** in **any programming language**

What's an Array?



- Each hotel room has a number (*index*)
- Hotel rooms are side-by-side (*contiguous*)
- You are in room 202? Go to room 205 by walking 3 rooms after.

What's an Array?

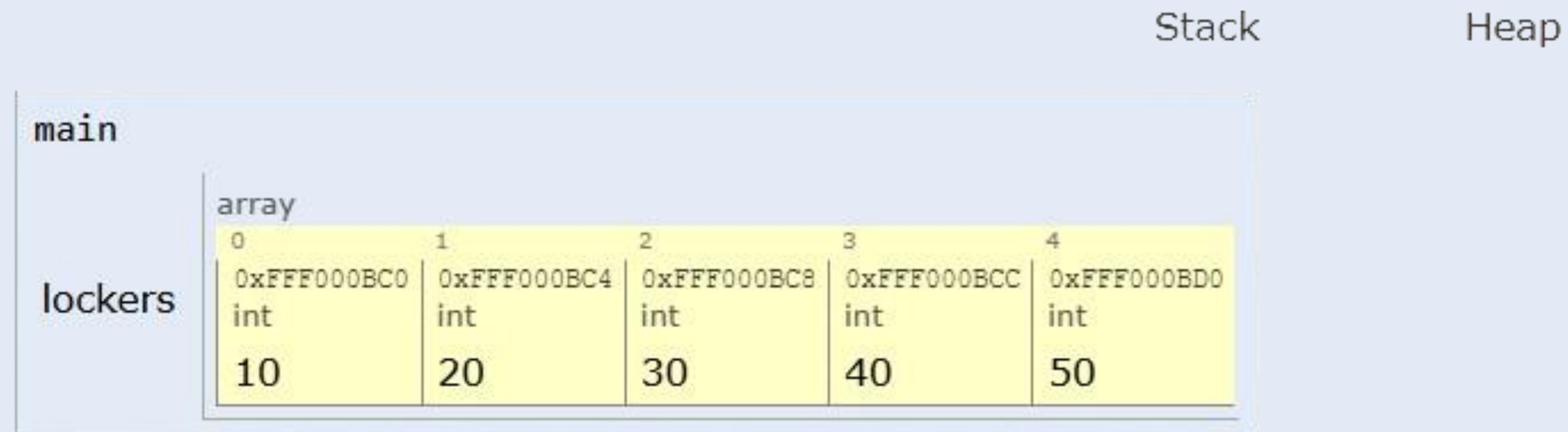
in the case of C++?

same-type

Contiguous blocks of memory storing [^] items.

```
1 int lockers[5] = {10, 20, 30, 40, 50}; // 5 adjacent integers
```

Memory Representation



Base adress + (index * size type) = Location of **arr[index]**

Example: lockers[2] = 0xFFFF000BC0 + (2 × 4 bytes) = 0xFFFF000BC8 → 30

Memory Representation

Why do you **CARE**?

💡 Access is $O(1)$: CPU calculates address instantly

Searching an Element

```
1 int linearSearch(int arr[], int size, int key) {  
2     for (int i = 0; i < size; i++) { // Start at 0!  
3         if (arr[i] == key) return i; // Found? Return index.  
4     }  
5     return -1; // Not found  
6 }
```

Searching an Element

```
1 int linearSearch(int arr[], int size, int key) {  
2     for (int i = 0; i < size; i++) { // Start at 0!  
3         if (arr[i] == key) return i; // Found? Return index.  
4     }  
5     return -1; // Not found  
6 }
```

- Array is not sorted
- $O(n)$

Searching an Element

```
1  int binarySearch(int arr[], int size, int key) {
2      int left = 0, right = size - 1; // right = size-1 (not size)!
3      while (left <= right) {
4          int mid = left + (right - left) / 2; // Avoid overflow!
5          if (arr[mid] == key) return mid;
6          else if (arr[mid] < key) left = mid + 1;
7          else right = mid - 1;
8      }
9      return -1;
10 }
```

Searching an Element

```
1 int binarySearch(int arr[], int size, int key) {
2     int left = 0, right = size - 1; // right = size-1 (not size)!
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5         if (arr[mid] == key) return mid;
6         else if (arr[mid] < key) left = mid + 1;
7         else right = mid - 1;
8     }
9     return -1;
10 }
```

- Array must be sorted
- $O(\log n)$
- logarithm in base 2, why?
 - the search space is **halved**

Inserting an Element

```
1 void insert(int arr[], int& size, int cap, int k, int value) {  
2     if (size >= cap) { cout << "Array Full!"; return; }  
3     for (int i = size; i > k; i--) { // Start from the end!  
4         arr[i] = arr[i - 1];          // Shift right  
5     }  
6     arr[k] = value;  
7     size++;  
8 }
```

Inserting an Element

```
1 void insert(int arr[], int& size, int cap, int k, int value) {
2     if (size >= cap) { cout << "Array Full!"; return; }
3     for (int i = size; i > k; i--) { // Start from the end!
4         arr[i] = arr[i - 1];        // Shift right
5     }
6     arr[k] = value;
7     size++;
8 }
```

- Insert at position k
- O(n)

Inserting an Element

```
1 void insertAtEnd(int arr[], int& size, int cap, int value) {  
2     if (size >= cap) { cout << "Array Full!"; return; }  
3     arr[size++] = value;  
4 }
```

Inserting an Element

```
1 void insertAtEnd(int arr[], int& size, int cap, int value) {  
2     if (size >= cap) { cout << "Array Full!"; return; }  
3     arr[size++] = value;  
4 }
```

- Insert at the end
- $O(1)$

Deleting an Element

```
1 void deleteAt(int arr[], int& size, int k) {
2     for (int i = k; i < size - 1; i++) { // Stop at size-2!
3         arr[i] = arr[i + 1];           // Shift left
4     }
5     size--;
6 }
```

Deleting an Element

```
1 void deleteAt(int arr[], int& size, int k) {  
2     for (int i = k; i < size - 1; i++) { // Stop at size-2!  
3         arr[i] = arr[i + 1];           // Shift left  
4     }  
5     size--;  
6 }
```

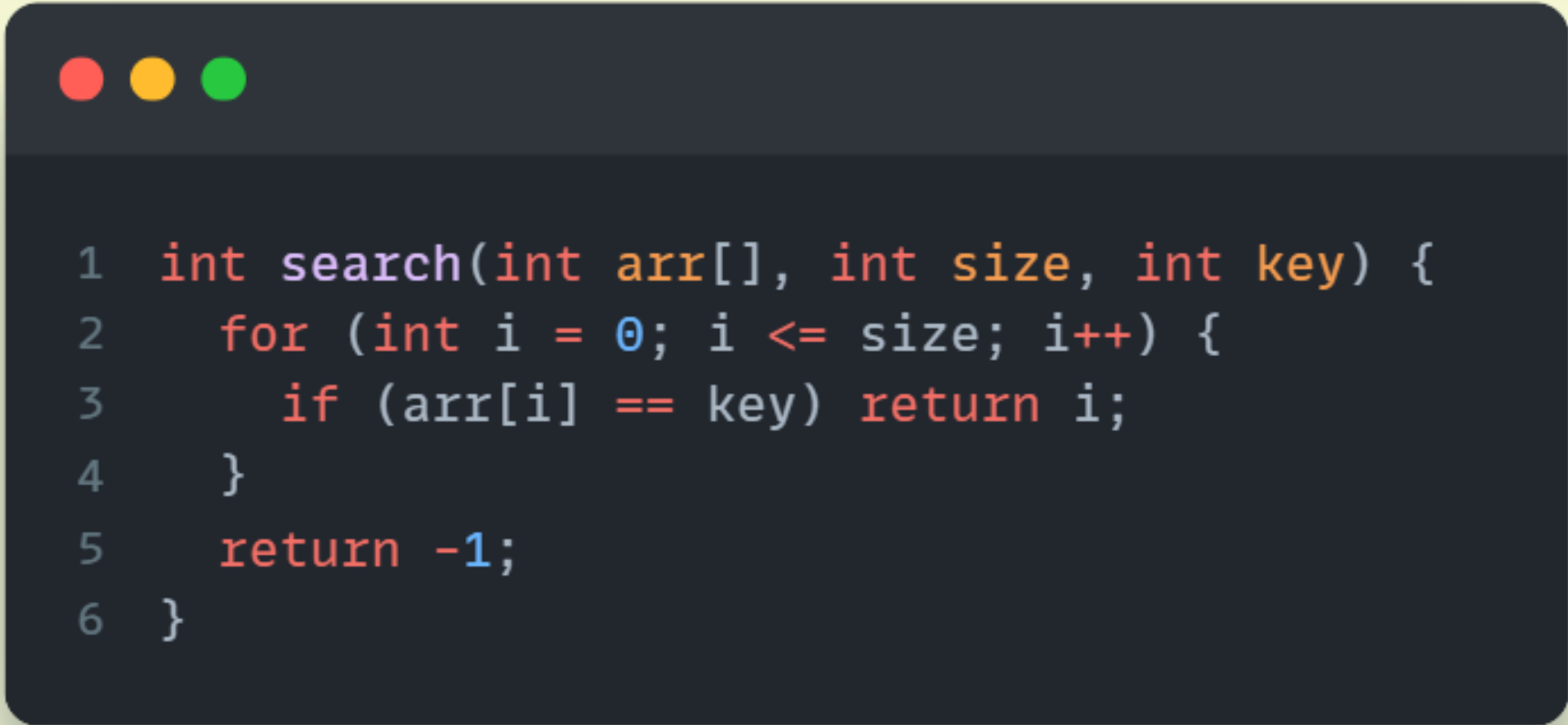
- Delete element at index k
- $O(n)$

Complexity of Array Operations

OPERATION	TIME COMPLEXITY	WHY?
Access at position k	$O(1)$	Pointer arithmetic
Linear search	$O(n)$	Search all elements; worst case found at the last
Binary search	$O(\log n)$	Halve search space in each iteration
Insert at position k	$O(n)$	Worst case insertion at index 0 shift all elements to the right
Insert at rear	$O(1)$	No shifting of elements; location is pointer arithmetic
Delete at position k	$O(n)$	Worst case deletion at index 0 shift all elements to the left

Debugging Array Errors

1. Off-by-one



```
1  int search(int arr[], int size, int key) {  
2      for (int i = 0; i <= size; i++) {  
3          if (arr[i] == key) return i;  
4      }  
5      return -1;  
6  }
```

Debugging Array Errors

1. Off-by-one

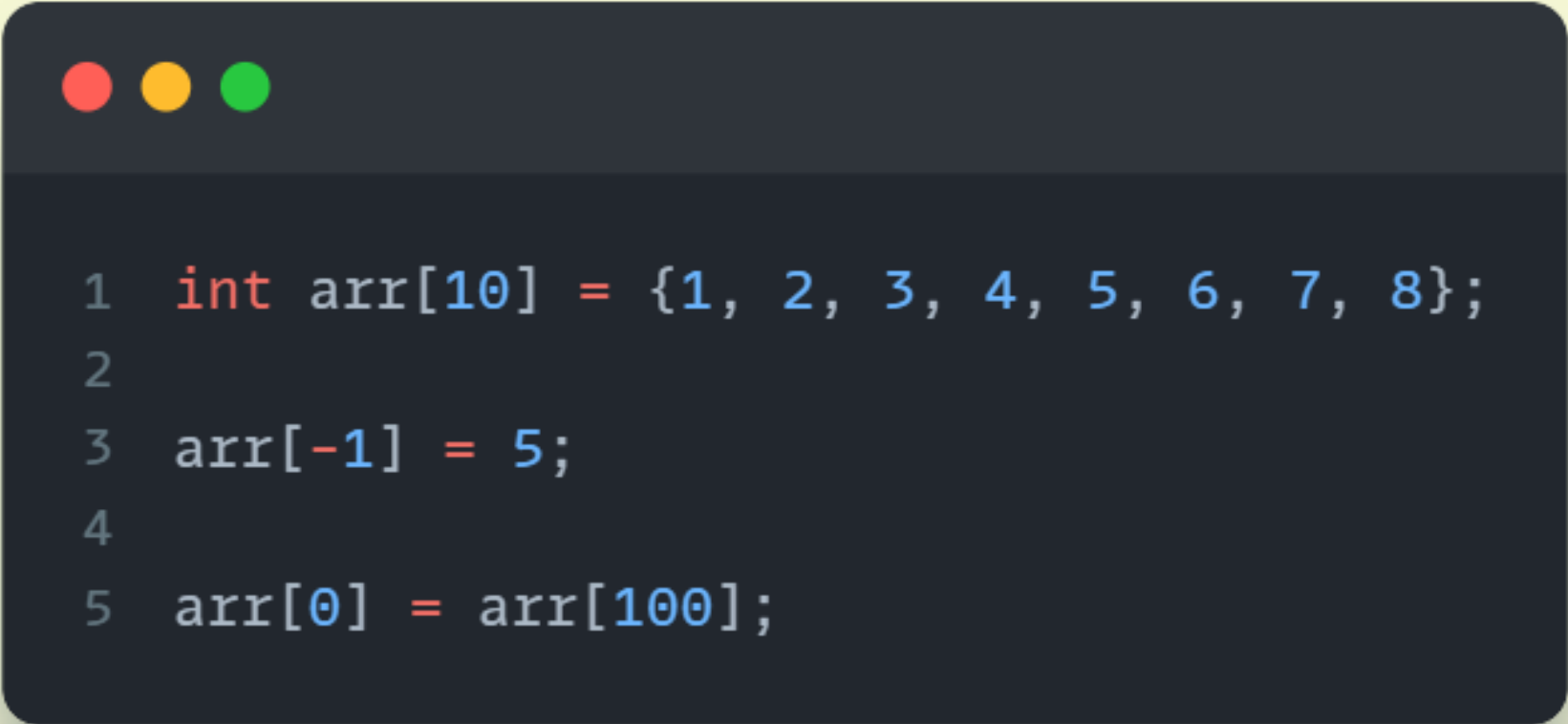
```
1 int search(int arr[], int size, int key) {  
2     for (int i = 0; i <= size; i++) {  
3         if (arr[i] == key) return i;  
4     }  
5     return -1;  
6 }
```

✗ Line 2 include `i = size`
Line 3 accesses `arr[size]`

✓ `i < size` (valid indices: 0 to size-1)

Debugging Array Errors

2. Out-of-bounds access / Buffer overflow or underflow



```
1  int arr[10] = {1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8};  
2  
3  arr[-1] = 5;  
4  
5  arr[0] = arr[100];
```

Debugging Array Errors

2. Out-of-bounds access / Buffer overflow or underflow

```
1  int arr[10] = {1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8};  
2  
3  arr[-1] = 5;  
4  
5  arr[0] = arr[100];
```

✗ Line 3 accesses a negative index
Line 5 accesses > index 9 (size - 1)

✓ Only access index between 0 and size - 1

Debugging Array Errors

3. *Forgetting to update size*

Always update size after insertion/deletion

4. *Shift direction errors*

Insertion: shift **right** (start from *end*)

Deletion: shift **left** (start from *position*)

Applications

Arrays are **EVERYWHERE!**

Caches, matrices in image processing, databases, OOP collections, etc.

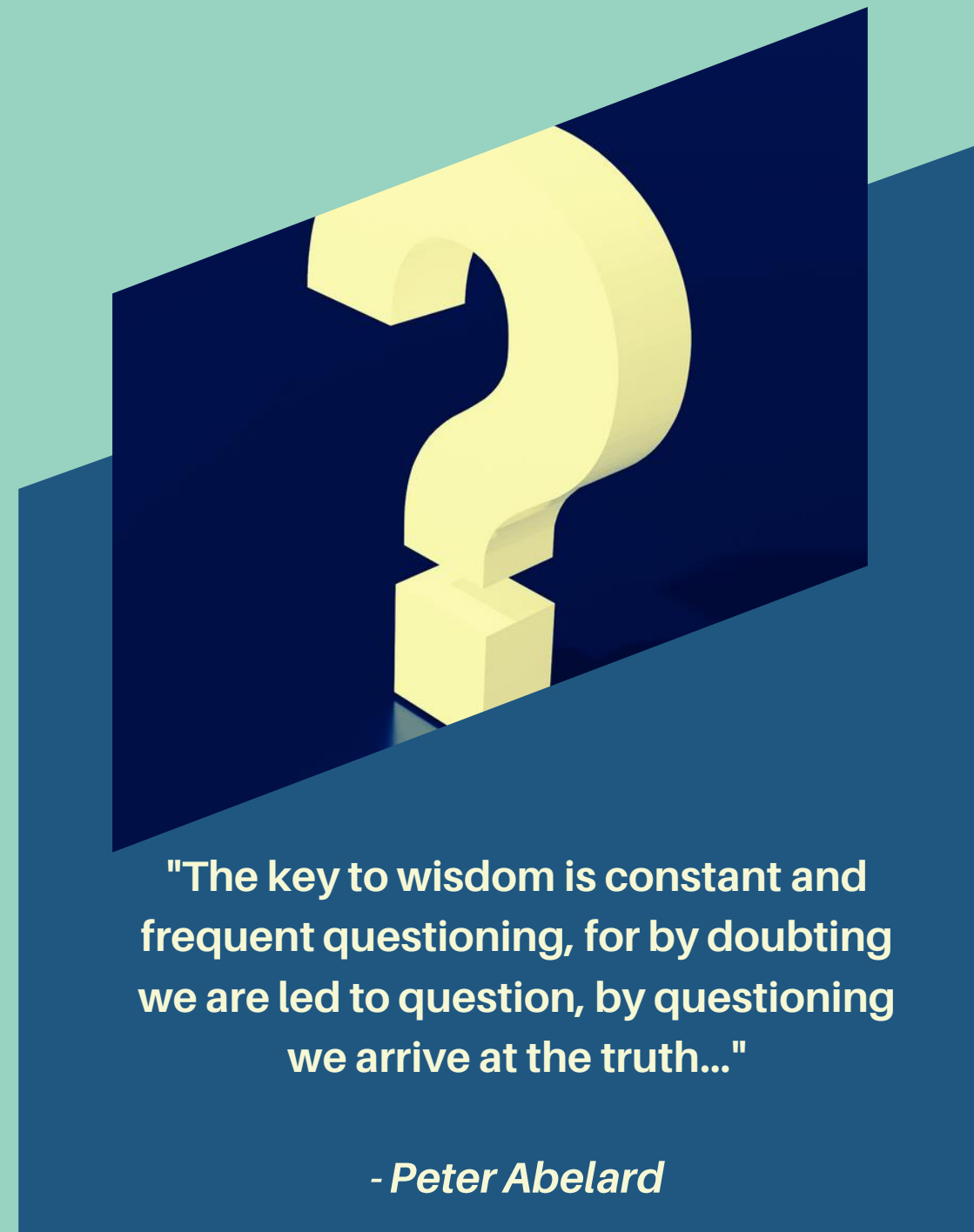
Limitations

Static/stack arrays → fixed size

Dynamic arrays (vectors) fixes this but **huge memory footprint**

Golden Rule

*“Contiguous memory = lightning-fast access.
Shifting elements = costly.
Choose wisely.”*



OPEN FORUM Q/A

for Module 1